Zulia Conservancy
UGANDA

OPPORTUNITY · CONSERVATION FUNDS

Case for support

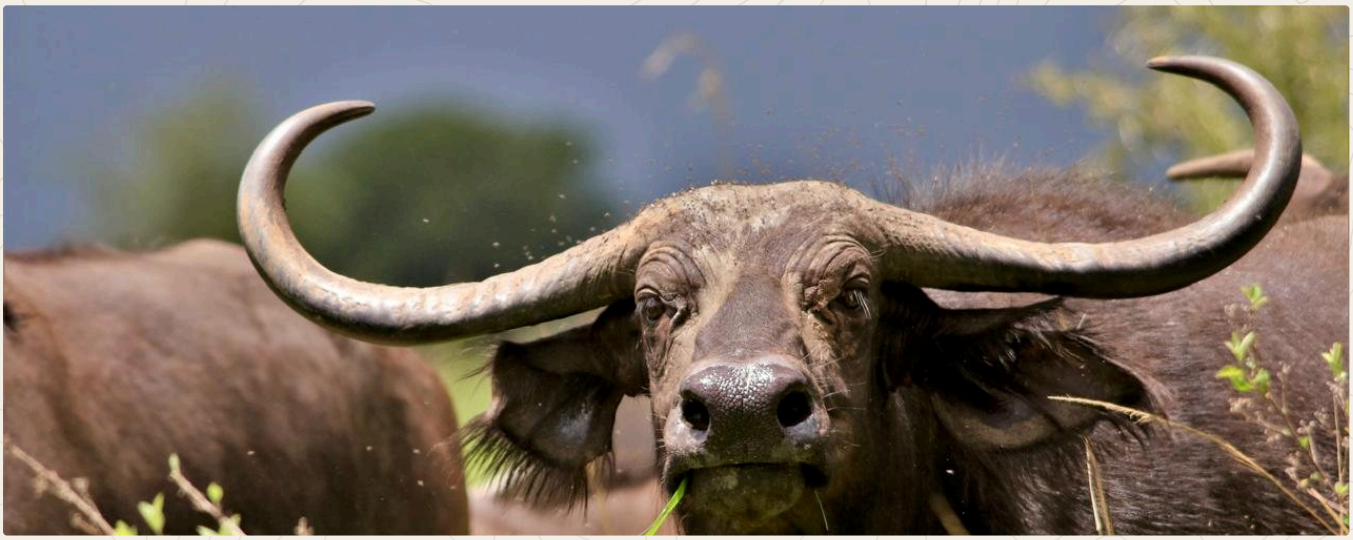
Help protect and restore the high ground of the Kidepo ecosystem.

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A mountain worth saving

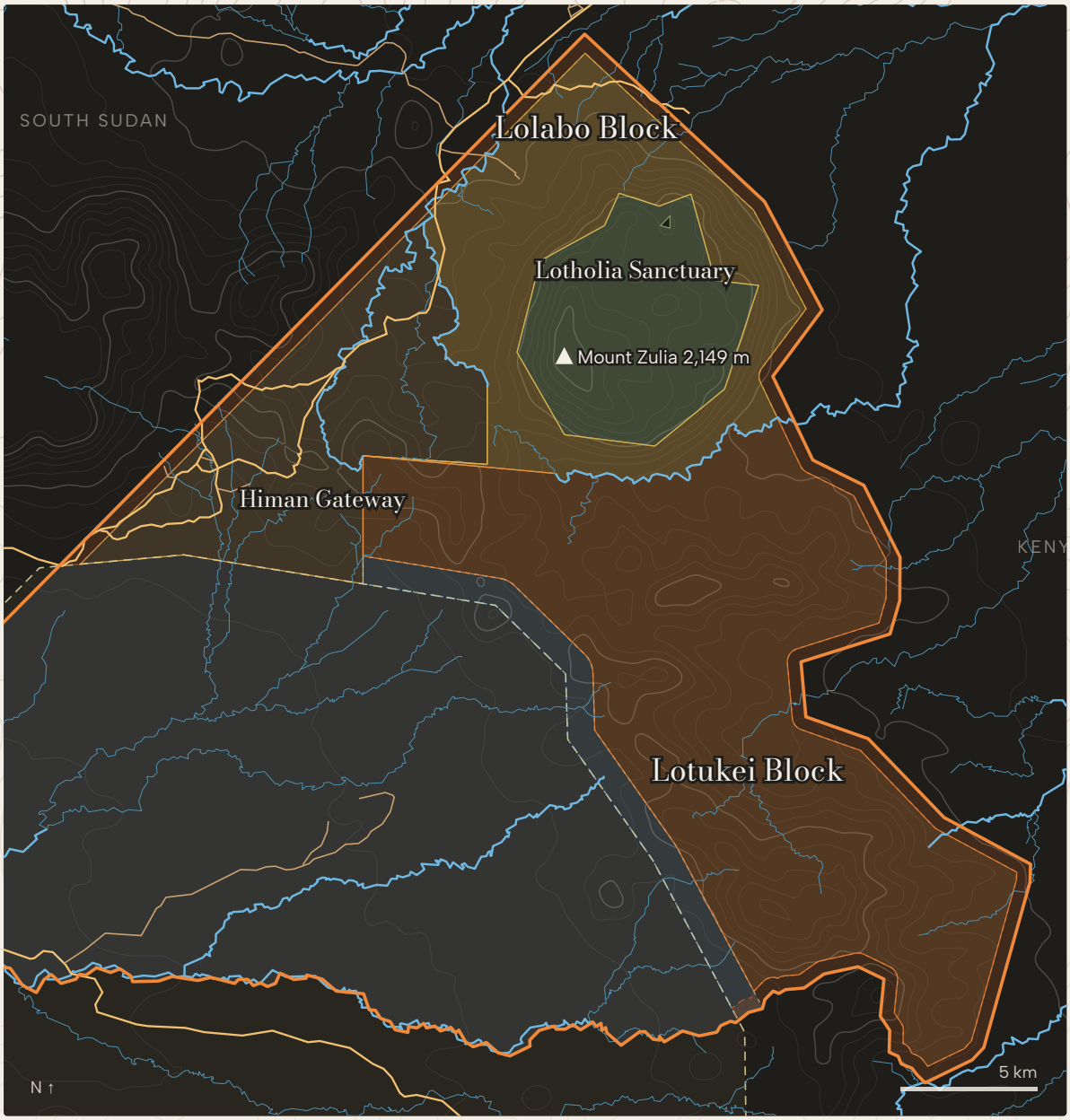
Mount Zulia rises 2,149 metres above the Kidepo valley in Uganda's far north-east, where Uganda meets South Sudan and Kenya. Its forest reserve, 1,029 km² of granite domes, plateau and escarpment (about 410 km² of it inside Kidepo Valley National Park, managed jointly with the Uganda Wildlife Authority), is the high ground of the Kidepo ecosystem: the dry-season refuge, the water tower and the corridor between Kidepo Valley National Park and the wild country beyond the borders.

For decades the reserve was unmanaged. Roan, eland, oryx and hartebeest are gone or nearly gone; elephant and buffalo move through but rarely stay; fires, charcoal and raiding cut deeper every year. In 2022 Uganda's National Forestry Authority granted Zulia Conservancy a 50-year licence to manage and restore it, with the people of Kaabong as partners.



Buffalo on the Zulia plateau.

What we protect



The reserve and its management zones: a gateway at Himan, a no-hunting sanctuary on the summit, two sustainable-use blocks, and the buffers along the park and the border.

WHAT YOUR SUPPORT DOES

Rangers, wildlife, people, science

Rangers

A force of 40 community rangers, outposts, vehicles and air support, working with Uganda Wildlife Authority.

Wildlife return

Breeding enclosures that bring back roan, eland, oryx, hartebeest and gazelle in numbers, for Zulia and for other parks.

Community

Jobs, scholarships and enterprise for the Ik and Dodoth communities, and a share of every visitor's fee.

Science

An aerial count, camera traps, botanical survey and long-term monitoring, open to Ugandan universities.

Earned income

Lodges, walking, birding and sustainable use already pay a growing share of the bill.

Accountability

An independent trust, audited accounts and a public annual report.

Protecting a reserve of this size costs about **US$1 million a year** at full strength: in line with the published benchmark for well-managed African protected areas. Tourism and sustainable use will meet a growing part of it. The rest, and the capital for the breeding programme and ranger infrastructure, will come from people and institutions who want the high ground of Kidepo to stay wild.

WAYS TO GIVE

Partnership, not charity

Foundation and institutional partners	Multi-year support for a programme: rangers, wildlife return, community, science.
Patrons	Individuals and families who commit for three years, with an annual visit to Zulia.
Programme sponsorship	Name a ranger outpost, a breeding enclosure, a scholarship or the aerial count.
Capital	Breeding programme, ranger headquarters, airstrip and tracks.
In kind	Flying hours, vehicles, equipment, scientific and legal expertise.

Gifts are received by the Zulia Conservation Trust (in formation), a not-for-profit Ugandan company with its own board and audited accounts, and, for donors in the United States, through a tax-deductible partner organisation.



A vulture over the Zulia escarpment.

EXPRESSIONS OF INTEREST

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We are glad to brief foundations and patrons in person, in Kampala, London, Nairobi or the United States, and to host visits to Zulia.